



English 3 Honors

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 11 · FULL YEAR

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Rooted in the classical tradition and focused on the American experience, English 3 Honors asks scholars to examine the relationship between the individual and society through dystopian fiction, American storytelling, and Shakespearean tragedy. Through close reading, Socratic discussion, literary analysis, and creative expression, scholars confront enduring questions about freedom, truth, justice, conformity, and power. Honors scholars work with greater text complexity and more independent analysis, and the year blends classical rigor with regular work on Optima's VR campus: monologue performances, research galleries, and immersive scenes from the texts.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

Q1 Censorship, Rebellion, and Society (9 weeks)

Fahrenheit 451. A digital escape-room launch, the Banned, Burned, Broadcast VR research gallery, character monologues, and a literary analysis essay and final exam.

Q2 Control, Identity, and the Cost of Stability (9 weeks)

Brave New World. Argument writing on truth versus stability, modern connections (technology, conformity), a theme world room, and an alternative-ending cinematic scene.

Q3 American Storytelling (9 weeks)

Washington Irving's tales (Rip Van Winkle, Sleepy Hollow) in this section: a character documentary-trailer project, a courtroom VR case study, and the quarter's final essay and exam.

Q4 Madness, Power, and the Human Psyche (9 weeks)

Hamlet, act by act: soliloquy and character analysis, theme work on appearance versus reality, and a final essay and final project.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Reading days with guided questions move scholars through the current text at a steady pace.
- A written response most weeks: analysis paragraphs, argument drafts, reflections, and quizzes that build toward each quarter's essay.
- VR experiences woven through the quarter on Optima's VR campus: galleries, simulations, recorded monologues, and discussions.
- Each quarter closes with a major project or essay plus a whole-text exam.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- Daily lesson and reading fill most of the scheduled time.
- Project and exam weeks (quarter ends) may run longer as drafts become final work.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- The core texts — digital copies of several are provided inside the course; a personal copy is welcome.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas; a microphone for recorded performances.
- Access to Optima's VR campus for galleries, performances, and discussions.
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for essays and projects.

Grading at a glance: Exams and Essays 35% · Classwork 25% · Projects 25% · Homework 15%

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily as a core course.